

FAST BOWLERS – Observations using back view and side view.

Master table:

Category	Back View Observations	Side View Observations
1. Run-up & Approach	- Alignment of run-up path (straight/drift) - Lateral movement during approach - Entry angle into crease	- Momentum build-up through strides - Acceleration pattern - Rhythm & timing of last 5–6 steps
2. Gather / Pre-delivery Jump	- Alignment into jump - Sideways sway during gather - Shoulder line direction	- Jump height/length - Smoothness of landing transition - Balance and posture in air
3. Back Foot Contact (BFC)	- Angle of back foot landing (open/closed/parallel) - Hip & shoulder alignment - Lateral collapse or drift	- Torso position at BFC (upright/lean forward/back) - Transition timing from jump to BFC - Beginning of hip–shoulder separation
4. Front Foot Contact (FFC)	- Front foot alignment (straight/cross-over/wide) - Shoulder–hip alignment relative to target - Head position over landing	- Bracing of front leg - Knee flexion at landing - Hip drop or lower-body stability
5. Alignment & Sequencing	- Straight-line vs cross-body action - Lateral trunk lean - Shoulder rotation direction	- Trunk flexion amount - Hip–shoulder separation timing - Core stability during rotation
6. Bowling Arm Mechanics	- Arm path direction (straight/angled) - Alignment of arm relative to body - Release line (wide/close to stumps)	- Arm height (high/$\frac{3}{4}$/round-arm) - Arm speed/whip efficiency - Smoothness of arc leading to release
7. Non-Bowling Arm Mechanics	- Alignment of non-bowling arm on pull down - Early collapse or cross-body pull	- Strength and timing of pull-down - Effect on trunk rotation & pace generation
8. Release Point	- Lateral release position (close/wide) - Initial angle of ball trajectory - Shoulder alignment at release	- Release height - Release point relative to front foot (ahead/on top/behind) - Wrist position & seam presentation
9. Ball Characteristics	- Ball angle: inswing/out-swing cues - Starting line off the hand	- Wrist flexion timing - Seam position during release - Length indicators (trajectory)
10. Follow-through	- Direction of follow-through (straight/falling away) - Balance after release	- Momentum continuation - Smooth versus abrupt deceleration - Body posture on landing
11. Stride Length	- Lateral stride direction consistency	- Overstride/understride tendencies - Consistency across deliveries

12. Head Position & Stability	- Side leaning (off/leg side) - Alignment with target	- Vertical stability - Head drop or rise from FFC to release
13. Use of Crease	- Close-to-stumps vs wide-of-crease angle	- Overstepping/no-ball risk - Relative position to popping crease
14. Angle Creation & Tactics	- Natural angle created at release - Bowler's preferred channel	- Ability to change length/trajectory - Variation cues (bouncer/yorker/cutters)
15. Injury Risk Indicators	- Excessive counter-rotation - Hip–shoulder misalignment - Lateral trunk collapse	- Front leg collapse - Excessive trunk flexion - Sudden blocking of follow-through

Front view:

Run-up Line & Approach Path

- Whether the bowler runs **straight to the crease** or drifts sideways.
 - Any **curves in the run-up** that may affect momentum or alignment.
 - Consistency of the run-up path: does he enter the crease in the same channel every ball?
-

Alignment of Shoulders & Hips

- Shoulder rotation relative to the target line.
 - **Side-on / Front-on / Mixed action** can be clearly identified.
 - Hip direction as the bowler loads up—hips opening too early or staying closed.
 - Whether shoulders and hips stay **in the same plane** or cross excessively → injury risk.
-

Foot Placement at Back Foot Contact (BFC)

- Does the back foot land **parallel, closed, or open**?
 - Angle of the foot relative to the popping crease.
 - Stability of the back-foot landing—ankle collapse, wobble, heel-toe landing issues.
-

Alignment at Front Foot Contact (FFC)

- Front foot landing line:
 - **Straight** vs **crossing the body** vs **falling away wide**.
 - Impact on natural angle:
 - Right-arm bowler going wide = natural outswing.
 - Crossing over = induces inswing/angle in.
 - Heel-toe landing: smooth? harsh? unstable?
-

Lateral Movement & Body Sway

- Whether the head/torso **leans to the off-side or leg-side** in gather or delivery.
 - The extent of lateral collapse during landing → reduces pace & accuracy.
-

Arm Path & Alignment (Bowling Arm + Non-bowling Arm)

- Does the bowling arm come **straight up behind the body** or drift to the side?
 - Non-bowling arm direction → crucial for:
 - Straight-line force
 - Pulling power
 - Maintaining alignment
 - Check for **early collapse** of the non-bowling arm.
-

Release Point Consistency

- Vertical release height—consistent or fluctuating?
 - Lateral release point—wide, close to stumps, or falling away.
 - Tendency to release behind the body → loss of control.
-

Follow-through Path

- Straight follow-through towards batter = good energy transfer.
 - Falling away to the off/leg side = alignment issue.
 - Amount of “spin-out” after release → indicates body imbalance.
-

Stride Length Symmetry

- Whether stride is consistent across deliveries.
 - Overstriding or understriding can be seen clearly from the back.
-

Ball Angle Out of the Hand

- Initial angle of ball trajectory:
 - Out-swinger tends to leave the hand slightly wider.
 - In-swinger tends to come from inside the line.
 - Any changes in seam position based on the hand-path (only partially visible but still useful).
-

Use of Crease

- Bowling from wide of the crease vs close to stumps.
 - Tactical advantage:
 - Right-arm over wide = angle across LHB.
 - Close to stumps = target stumps more often.
-

Rhythm & Tempo

- Smooth acceleration into the crease vs sudden stop/start patterns.
 - Consistency in number of steps, timing, and momentum.
-

Injury Red Flags

- Excessive trunk bend to one side.
- Contradicting shoulder–hip alignment.
- Knee collapse at FFC.
- Over-rotation or counter-rotation.

Side view:

Run-up Speed, Rhythm & Momentum Build-up

- Ability to **increase pace gradually** through the run-up.
 - Smooth or jerky rhythm during the final 5–6 strides.
 - Does he decelerate before take-off → major pace loss indicator.
-

Gather & Pre-delivery Jump Mechanics

- Height and length of the jump.
 - Whether the jump is **balanced** or causes the bowler to fall away.
 - Efficiency of weight transfer during jump → crucial for momentum conversion.
-

Back Foot Contact (BFC) — Timing & Body Position

- How quickly the bowler transitions from jump to BFC.
 - Body posture at BFC: upright, leaning back, or leaning forward.
 - The exact moment of **shoulder-hip separation** beginning.
-

Front Foot Contact (FFC) — Bracing & Stability

- Knee flexion angle at FFC (ideal: slightly bent then braced).
- Whether the front leg **collapses**, stays **rigid**, or braces **late**.
- Level of hip drop — excessive drop = pace loss + injury risk.

Shoulder–Hip Separation (Sequencing)

- Side view clearly shows the timing:
 - **Hips rotate first**, shoulders follow → generates torque.
- Over-rotation or under-rotation visible clearly on this angle.
- Whether timing is early, late, or optimal.

Trunk Flexion

- Amount of forward lean during release.
- Is the bowler:
 - **Too upright** → less pace, lower release.
 - **Too bent** → injury risk to back and hamstrings.

Arm Path & Bowling Arm Speed

- Height of the arm at release (high, three-quarter, round-arm).
- Smoothness of arm path — straight arc or looping/lagging action.
- Side view helps quantify arm speed and whip efficiency.

Non-bowling Arm Mechanics

- Extension, pulling action, and timing of the front-arm.
- Collapsing too early → massive impact on pace & seam position.
- Pull strength visible clearly in this view.

Release Point — Height, Angle & Body Alignment

- Point of release relative to front foot.
- Release height in relation to bowler's head.
- Release position: slightly ahead / on top / behind front foot.

- Angle of release trajectory — full length, back of a length, short.
-

Follow-through Mechanics

- Whether the bowler maintains forward momentum.
 - Sudden stop or “block” in the follow-through → stress on back and knees.
 - Smooth deceleration pattern and stability.
-

Stride Length & Consistency

- Side view clearly shows:
 - Overstriding
 - Understriding
 - Inconsistent stride length in spells
 - How stride length adjusts for different deliveries.
-

Head Position & Stability

- Whether the head stays still or wobbles.
 - Head falling to one side → alignment problem.
 - Eye-level drop or rise from FFC to release.
-

Bowling Boundaries — Front Foot vs Back Foot Positioning

- How far behind/over the crease the bowler lands.
 - Side view shows no-ball risks more clearly.
-

Energy Transfer Efficiency

- How much of the run-up momentum gets transferred into the ball.
 - Wasted energy in sideways movement or excessive vertical jump.
 - Whether the bowler is a “horizontal momentum” or “vertical jump” based bowler.
-

Ball Release Cues

- Point where the ball starts rotating.
- Wrist position at release: upright/seam-up, angled, scrambled.
- Speed of wrist flexion.